Walking on Ancient Ground: Detective Hunt Log Book questions

Name: _____ **Class:** _____ **Date:** _____

These questions go with the book's Detective Hunt Log Book. They ask students to check sources, notice silences and say how sure they are.

Before you read: sources

1. Who wrote each of the five fragments, and who did they write it for?

2. Which fragments were written at the time? Which were written later?

3. What does "redacted" mean? Who might remove a name from a record?

The Resistor

4. The book says the Resistor is "archetypal". What is an archetype, and why might a writer use one instead of a named person?

5. Which parts of the Resistor's story match the records? Which do not?

How sure am I? Circle one: 1 = not sure at all, 5 = very sure (1) (2) (3) (4) (5)

6. The records call him a "murderer" and an "enemy". Whose words are those? What other words could describe him?

Thomas Freeman

7. Freeman's choices lead to different ends. Which choice would you make, and why?

8. Tench wrote that he asked Phillip to change an order. What does that tell you about Tench? What does it not tell you?

9. If a person in a story is not named in the records you have found, does that mean he did not exist?

How sure am I? Circle one: 1 = not sure at all, 5 = very sure (1) (2) (3) (4) (5)

Thomas Curtis

10. Why did the Curtis family leave England? Which records support the book's reasons?

How sure am I? Circle one: 1 = not sure at all, 5 = very sure (1) (2) (3) (4) (5)

11. The book gives Warra no words. What can a story tell us about a person who has no words, and what can it not tell us?

12. What would you want to ask Warra? Who is the right person to answer?

Comparing records

13. Pick one clash from the Board. Which side do you trust more, and why?

How sure am I? Circle one: 1 = not sure at all, 5 = very sure **1** **2** **3** **4** **5**

14. Why is it important to keep what a story says apart from what the records say?

15. Whose voices are missing from the records you have seen? How could you find out more safely?

Spot the Discrepancy: questions for the whole class

Cases: 1. The march with no fight · 2. When was "last December"? · 3. How many days on the Andromache? · 4. When was the Sirius wrecked?

16. Pick one case. Which source is closer to the event, and does that make it more reliable?

How sure am I? Circle one: 1 = not sure at all, 5 = very sure **1** **2** **3** **4** **5**

17. In which case is the difference most likely a choice by the writer, and what in the evidence tells you?

18. In which case could the record itself be wrong? What would you check to find out?

How sure am I? Circle one: 1 = not sure at all, 5 = very sure (1) (2) (3) (4) (5)

19. Choose a case that stays open. What source would you look for next?

Writing task: a source check

About 20 minutes. Aim for 150 to 250 words in total.

1. Choose one clash from the Board.
2. Name the source in the book, and the record you compared it with.
3. Say what the two agree on and what they do not.
4. Say what is still missing, and who could fill the gap.

Sentence starters: The book says… · The record says… · They agree that… · They do not agree that… · I trust ____ more because… · I would want to know…

The book says…

The record says…

Where they agree and where they do not

What is still missing